PRODUCT TEARDOWN

smallcase

A storefront for portfolios, mid-pivot into a ledger for net worth.

20
screens reviewed

6 min
single session

12
defects logged

Evidence base: one uninterrupted Android session, 21:14–21:20, July 2026.

THE THESIS

Two products, two instincts, one losing

smallcase sells curated baskets built by third-party managers, executed through your existing broker. That is a transaction business with weak switching costs.

The screens with the most investment — Wealth Office, Ask AI, Forecast 2029, Credit, US equities — are aimed at a different job entirely:

Own the household ledger.

A basket is a purchase. A net worth is a relationship — and a switching cost.

The transaction layer

Polished, aggressive, shipping fast. 25% off on every card, ranked leaderboards, intent-based collections.

The trust layer

Shipping a headline net worth built on data that is sixteen months old, with a three-year forecast on top.

The tension

You cannot build a trust product on a transaction team's instincts. If the ledger loses, the storefront eventually does too.

COVERAGE

What this teardown saw — and what it did not

Surfaces covered

Content	Weekly Wrap — all 8 story cards
Discovery	Explore, Home rails, Trending, Take-your-pick, a Collection page
Creation	Create smallcase (empty state)
Account & nav	More tab, bottom nav, activation checklist
Wealth Office	Net worth, liabilities, asset grid, MF loader

Capture order is not a user journey — no intent is inferred from sequence.

Not covered — and therefore not claimed on

- Order placement and broker execution
- The Investments tab and existing holdings
- The Credit tab
- Search
- The subscription paywall and actual pricing
- First-run onboarding
- What the returns figures look like unlocked

ONE EXCEPTION

The Weekly Wrap is an authored linear story, and its own progress indicator fixes card position — the segment bars advance 1→8, and all eight are present. Claims about that ordering hold. Claims about ordering anywhere else do not.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Two users, one surface, and a gap between them

THE FIRST-TIMER

₹300 of spare cash · 1–2 years into earning

THE JOB

“Put this somewhere better than my savings account, without having to learn first.”

WHAT THAT NEEDS

A small first ticket, a track record they can see, and one decision to make.

WHAT THE APP GIVES

A ₹21,701 basket in the same rail as a ₹300 one, 1M returns behind a padlock, and the activation checklist three screens down.

THE CONSOLIDATOR

₹4.23L across six institutions · 5–10 years in

THE JOB

“Tell me what I am actually worth, then tell me what to do about it.”

WHAT THAT NEEDS

A ledger that is true, and advice that visibly follows from it.

WHAT THE APP GIVES

A headline net worth last synced in March 2025, a monthly delta it cannot verify, and a 2029 forecast drawn on top.

THE GAP The storefront is built for the first-timer and priced for the consolidator. The Wealth Office is built for the consolidator and shipped with the storefront’s instincts. Every finding that follows sits in that gap.

INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Three businesses are hiding in a hamburger menu

Bottom navigation

Home	Search	Invest	**Credit**	More

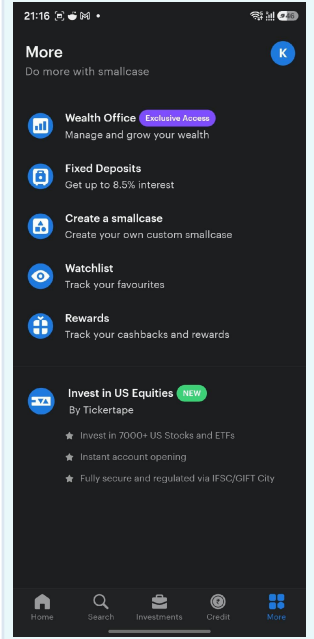
Credit sits at peer level with your portfolio

A lending surface one tap from everything, in an investing app. Placement that prominent is a revenue decision, not a usage-frequency one — almost certainly loan-against-securities, collateralising the holdings you just bought.

Four of six are businesses, not menu items. The net-worth platform and the international-equities product both sit behind the same hamburger.

What lives under “More”

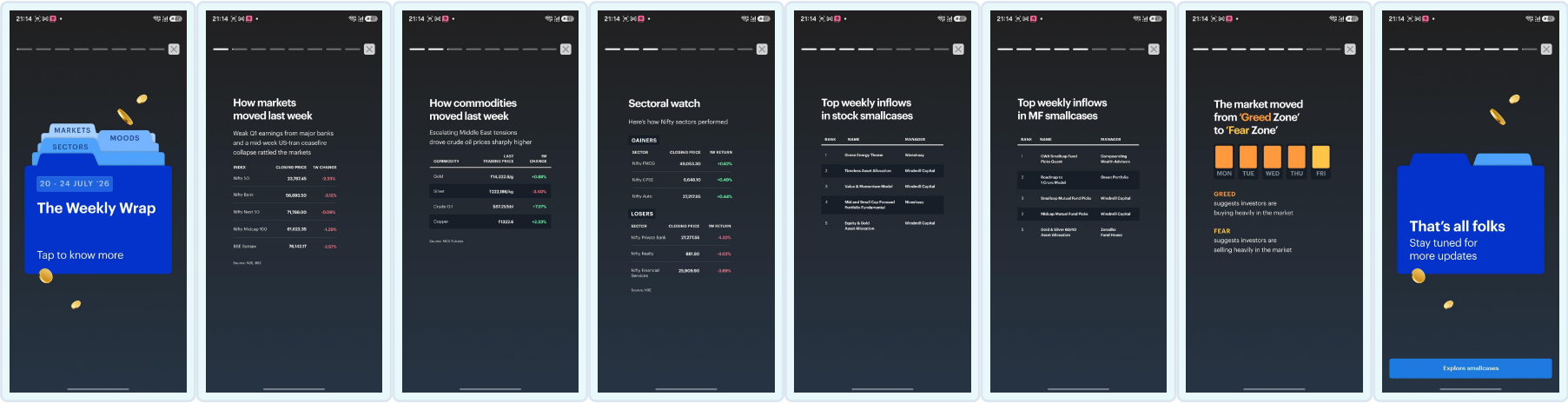
Wealth Office	*Exclusive Access*
Fixed Deposits	*up to 8.5% — distribution*
Create a smallcase	*the entire supply side*
Watchlist	*utility*
Rewards	*utility*
Invest in US Equities	*Tickertape, GIFT City*



More tab — 21:16

RETENTION LOOP

The Weekly Wrap is the best-built thing in the app



1 Intro | 2 Markets | 3 Commodities | 4 Sectors | 5 Stock inflows | 6 MF inflows | 7 Fear & Greed | 8 CTA

BUT Read the ordering: Nifty 50 −2.33% → Private Bank −4.32% → Fear & Greed flips to the Fear Zone → Explore smallcases. Ending a fear-framed sequence with a buy-adjacent CTA is a nudge, and it points at the exact behaviour that destroys retail returns. The wording of the fear card is neutral; the sequence is not.

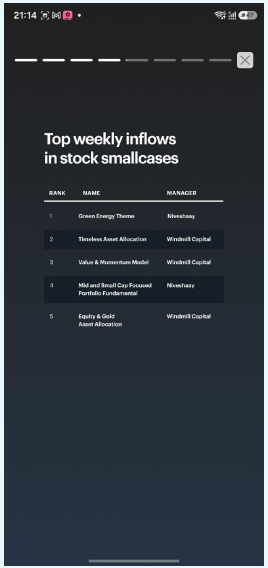
SOCIAL PROOF LOOP

The house is winning its own leaderboard

Top weekly inflows — stock smallcases

1	Green Energy Theme	Niveshaay
2	Timeless Asset Allocation	Windmill Capital
3	Value & Momentum Model	Windmill Capital
4	Mid and Small Cap Focused Portfolio	Niveshaay
5	Equity & Gold Asset Allocation	Windmill Capital

External context: Windmill Capital and Tickertape are both smallcase-group products — not visible in the screenshots.



Weekly Wrap, card 5 of 8 — 21:14

3 of 5

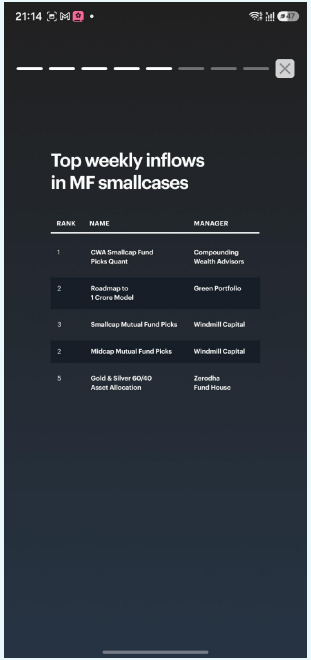
top stock baskets by inflow are Windmill Capital — smallcase's own in-house research arm.

GOVERNANCE

A marketplace ranking house brands on a leaderboard it computes itself, with no visual disclosure of the relationship. This is the Amazon Basics problem. It may be entirely earned — but it will get asked about externally.

EXHIBIT

The card whose only job is ranking, misranks



Weekly Wrap, card 6 of 8 — 21:14

Top weekly inflows in MF smallcases — as printed

1	CWA Smallcap Fund Picks Quant	
2	Roadmap to 1 Crore Model	
3	Smallcap Mutual Fund Picks	
2	Midcap Mutual Fund Picks	should be 4
5	Gold & Silver 60/40 Asset Allocation	

1, 2, 3, 2, 5

Rank 4 is printed as a second “2”. Row order is right; the numbering is not.

WHY IT MATTERS

A trivial fix, but a revealing one. This card is generated weekly and shipped without an editorial pass. If the ranking of other people’s money flows can go out wrong, every other number in the app inherits the doubt.

ACTIVATION LOOP

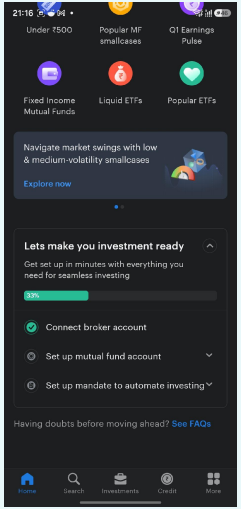
Correctly designed, incorrectly placed

Lets make you investment ready TYPO

33%

- Connect broker account
- Set up mutual fund account
- Set up mandate to automate investing

Textbook completion psychology — a partially filled bar is harder to abandon than an empty one.



Home, scrolled — 21:16

Why the order is right

The mandate is last because it is the highest-friction, highest-value step. A mandate converts a browser into recurring revenue and recurring AUM — it is the real activation event, not the first purchase.

Why the placement is wrong

It sits below three full screens of merchandising. The single highest-leverage activation surface in the app is buried under the storefront — and the storefront cannot convert users who are not yet investment-ready.

The mechanic works. It just needs to be seen.

DISCOVERY

The one number that matters is behind a padlock

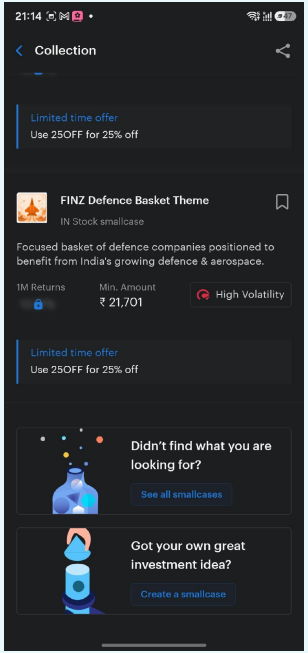
Nine collections, segmented by intent

Most Invested	Park & Earn	Newly Launched
Under ₹500	Popular MF	Q1 Earnings
Fixed Income MF	Liquid ETFs	Popular ETFs

These map to real mental states: I have spare cash, I'm broke, I want what's working, I'm reacting to news.

DISCOUNT

"Use 25OFF for 25% off" repeats on every card. At that density it stops reading as scarcity and starts reading as list price.



Collection page — 21:14

What the card shows you

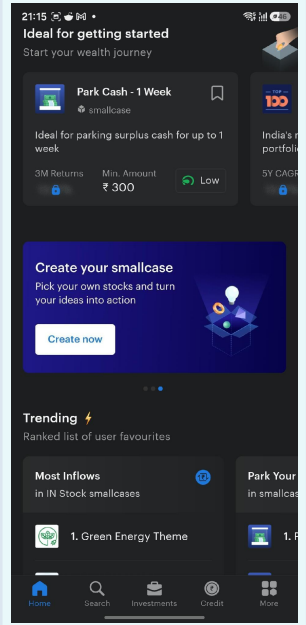
Min. Amount	₹21,701
Volatility	High
1M Returns	locked

INVERTED

In normal commerce you see quality and pay for access. Here it is reversed — so the visible fields become the decision, and users end up ranking baskets by minimum ticket size, which is close to meaningless.

CONVERSION LEAK

The 72× wall between onboarding and buying



Home rail — 21:15

72×

jump in minimum ticket, inside a single browsing surface

₹300

Park Cash – 1 Week

The onboarding promise — the beginner rail, badged "Ideal for getting started"

₹21,701

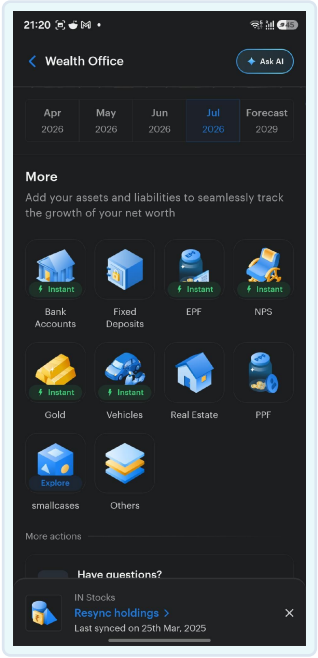
FINZ Defence Basket

A themed basket on a Collection page, in the same discovery surface

The "Under ₹500" collection exists because this cliff is known — but a collection is a workaround, not a fix.

THE STRATEGIC BET

Wealth Office is the right idea



Wealth Office — 21:20

What it aggregates

Bank Accounts	Fixed Deposits
EPF	**NPS**
Gold	**Vehicles**
Real Estate	PPF
smallcases	Others
Loans & Credits	Net worth + Forecast

Yellow = badged "Instant"

1 Switching cost

Once a household's EPF, gold, car and home loan all live in one place, leaving means rebuilding it elsewhere.

2 Underwriting signal

A complete asset and liability picture is exactly what the Credit tab needs to price risk.

3 Ground truth for AI

"Ask AI" is only as good as the ledger beneath it. No ledger, no advice worth charging for.

Not the product — the permission slip for what follows.

COMPETITION

The ledger is a land grab, and smallcase is late

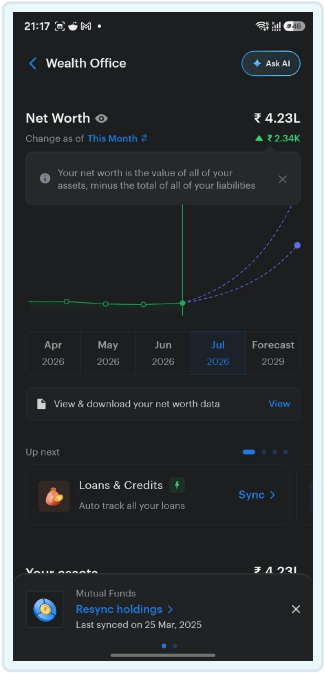
External context — none of this is visible in the session. Read from public product pages and announcements; directional, not audited.

Player	The ledger play	Where they are ahead	Where smallcase still wins
INDmoney	Net-worth dashboard across Indian and US stocks, MFs, bank accounts, NPS, EPF and FDs, plus a family view	Shipped this breadth years earlier, and owns the same US-equities adjacency	No supply side — smallcase has named managers and curated baskets
Groww	Track External Holdings — outside demat linked through the Account Aggregator framework, refreshing on its own	Already solved the sync problem on the next slide	Stops at securities, not the household balance sheet
Zerodha	Console consolidates holdings and adds a ten-account family view, inside Zerodha	Trust, and the most engaged retail base in India	Aggregates only itself — no outside institutions
Kuvera (CRED)	Portfolio consolidation, goal tracking and tax harvesting; CRED-owned since 2024	Distribution through CRED's affluent base	Execution through any broker, not one app's rails

Two things follow. The breadth is a real edge — nobody else aggregates vehicles, real estate and PPF, and that is the moat worth defending. But Groww already fixed the staleness problem through the Account Aggregator framework, the consent-based rail built for exactly this. The next slide is a solved problem, unsolved here.

CRITICAL FINDING

When the sync lapses, the number ships anyway



Wealth Office — 21:17

Mar 2025

Holdings last synced

"Last synced on 25 Mar, 2025" — a dismissible toast

Jul 2026

Displayed as current

Net Worth ₹4.23L, ▲ ₹2.34K this month

2029

Forecast rendered

A dashed three-year projection cone

Why this is the worst possible bug here

A net-worth product's entire value is that the number is true. For any user whose sync has lapsed, the ▲₹2.34K delta is unverifiable and the forecast cone is precision theatre. The defect is not stale data — it is the confidence rendered on top. Ask AI reads the same inputs.

The fix is not a bigger toast

- Degrade the number — grey it, stamp "as of Mar 2025", suppress the delta
- Kill the forecast when inputs cannot support it
- Auto-resync on open; re-auth as the primary action, not a dismissible banner

MONETIZATION MAP

Acquire cheap, capture the ledger, monetize the adjacencies

Stream	Evidence in the session	Read
Basket subscriptions	25OFF / 25% off; returns behind a padlock	Core, but discount-saturated
First-party supply	Windmill Capital across both leaderboards	Higher margin, undisclosed
Fixed deposits	“Get up to 8.5% interest” in More	Commission, low effort
Credit	Its own bottom-nav tab	High margin — needs Wealth Office data
US equities	Tickertape, via IFSC / GIFT City	Group cross-sell
Mandates	Step 3 of the activation checklist	Recurring AUM
Wealth Office	Free today, badged Exclusive Access	Data moat ⟶ future advisory

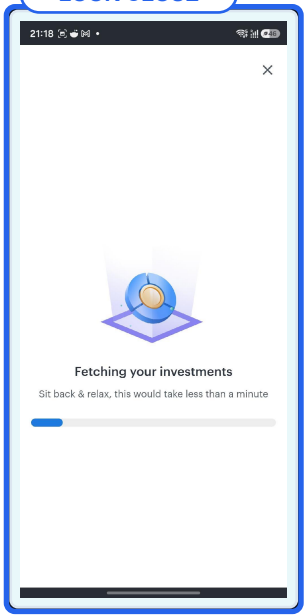
The shape is clear: content and cheap baskets acquire, Wealth Office captures the household picture, and the higher-margin adjacencies get monetized against it.

DEFECT LOG

Twelve issues in six minutes

#	Issue	Screen	Severity
1	Holdings 16 months stale; net worth, delta and 2029 forecast shown as current	Wealth Office	CRITICAL
2	Rank column reads 1, 2, 3, 2, 5 — rank 4 duplicated as “2”	Weekly Wrap	HIGH
3	“Fetching your investments” renders in light mode inside an all-dark app	MF import	HIGH
4	Sticky resync toast overlaps the “Your assets ₹4.23L” heading	Wealth Office	MEDIUM
5	Create empty state is a dead end — no templates, no fork-an-existing-basket	Create	MEDIUM
6	Two Create entry points (Home banner, More tab) with no shared state	Home / More	LOW
7	“Lets make you investment ready” — missing apostrophe	Home	LOW
8	“this would take less than a minute” — should be ‘will’	MF import	LOW
9	“Create a smallcase … track them” — number disagreement	Create	LOW
10	“25 Mar, 2025” vs “25th Mar, 2025” across two toasts	Wealth Office	LOW
11	“Explore” header collides with the status-bar clock	Explore	LOW
12	Carousel page dots rendered at the top edge, next to system icons	Home	LOW

LOOK CLOSE



Defect #3 — 21:18

Items 2 and 7–10 are cheap fixes. Their presence together signals something structural: there is no editorial or QA pass on the content pipeline — and a duplicated rank on a card whose whole job is ranking erodes trust in the data everywhere else.

STRATEGIC READ

What is working, and what is load-bearing but cracked

WORKING

- Content-as-retention is genuinely well built and structurally cheap to run
- Intent-based collections beat category browsing for beginners
- The Wealth Office thesis is right, and the aggregation breadth is ambitious in the right direction
- Bottom-of-funnel merchandising is sharp and well sequenced

FRAGILE

- Trust — stale data rendered as fresh is not recoverable with a redesign
- Neutrality — first-party baskets top a platform-computed leaderboard, undisclosed
- Pricing — a permanently available 25% off means the price never anchored
- Honesty of discovery — gating returns pushes the decision onto ticket size
- IA debt — three business lines hiding in the More menu

RECOMMENDATIONS

Trust first, then honesty — and how we would know

P0 Trust integrity

- Never render a net worth, delta or forecast from inputs past a staleness threshold
  Measure: share of Wealth Office views served a stale-flagged number, and resync completion within 7 days
- Auto-trigger resync on open; re-auth as the primary action, not a dismissible banner
  Measure: resync completion rate on prompt, and median days since last successful sync
- Fix the rank bug, then put a QA gate on the Weekly Wrap pipeline before publish
  Measure: content defects reaching production per issue — target zero

P1 Conversion honesty

- Show something on returns pre-unlock — a band, a percentile, a benchmark marker
  Measure: collection → basket-detail CTR, then detail → unlock rate
- Break the Fear → buy sequence: reorder the Wrap, or end it somewhere other than Explore
  Measure: card-8 CTA conversion, and the 90-day returns of users who enter through it
- Label first-party baskets on leaderboards, before someone else does it for you
  Measure: inflow share of Windmill baskets before and after labelling
- Test sunsetting the permanent 25% off — a dated cohort against a holdout, not a flip
  Measure: subscription conversion and ARPU, holdout versus discounted cohort

RECOMMENDATIONS

P2 — four structural changes, and what each should move

01

Promote Wealth Office into primary nav, and drop the Exclusive Access gate

Measure: Wealth Office reach among monthly actives, and 30-day retention of users who link at least one asset

02

Move the activation checklist above the merchandising rails on Home

Measure: broker-link rate among new installs by D7, and mandate set-up by D30

03

Give Create a real first step — fork an existing basket, or start from a screener template

Measure: baskets started per 1,000 eligible users, and the share that reach publish

04

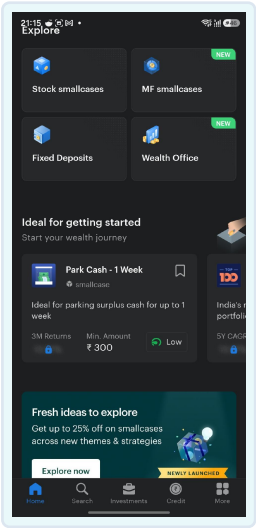
Attack the ₹300 → ₹21,701 cliff with fractional or SIP-into-basket entry

Measure: first-purchase rate for users whose first session begins in a sub-₹500 collection

Scope: interface and strategy read from one session's screenshots — no analytics, funnel data, pricing terms, or visibility into the regulatory constraints that may explain the returns gating. Nothing here is investment advice or a view on any basket, manager or security named.

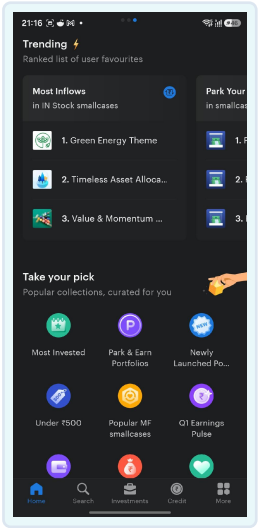
APPENDIX

The remaining screens in the corpus



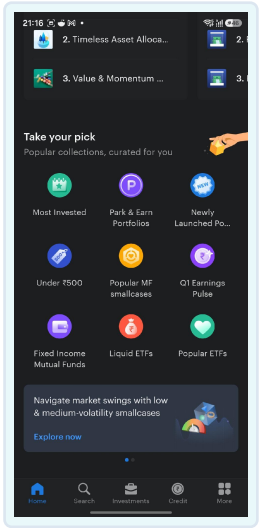
Explore

Four category tiles;
Wealth Office badged NEW



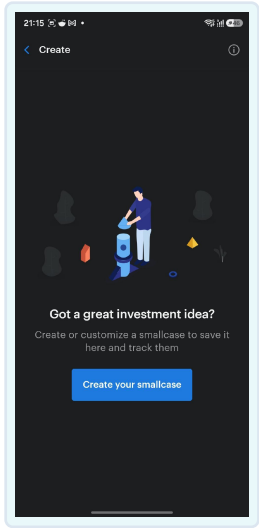
Trending

Ranked carousel above
the collections grid



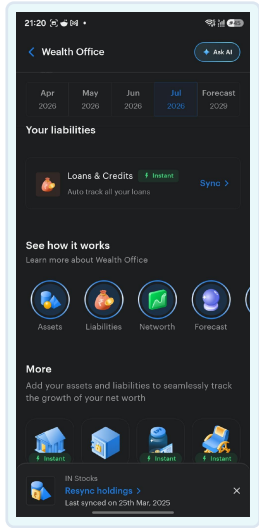
Take your pick

Nine collections; volatility
promo carousel below



Create

Empty state, single CTA,
no template or fork path



WO liabilities

Loans & Credits sync;
sticky resync toast again

IN ONE LINE

smallcase is building a trust product on top of a transaction product’s instincts.

The storefront is optimized hard and shipping fast. The ledger renders a confident headline number even when its own inputs have gone stale. The second was built because the first cannot hold a customer alone — so if the ledger loses, the storefront eventually does too.